

Practice Paper 3

Freedom and imprisonment; justice and mercy · Three hours · 100 marks

PAPER I · 40 MARKS

Answer **all** the questions in Section A. Select **either** I, II **or** III from Section B and answer all the questions given below it.

Paper I · Section A: Poetry, Prose and Drama 30 marks

Read the following extracts and answer all the questions given below them.

I POETRY

I (i) · PRACTICE QUESTION

"War is kind.
Hoarse, booming drums of the regiment
Little souls who thirst for fight,
These men were born to drill and die"

(a) Name the poem from which these lines are taken. Name the poet. 1 mark

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.....

(b) Who are the 'Little souls'? 1 mark

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.....

(c) Name a sound device in the second line. 1 mark

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.....

(d) What attitude to the soldiers is shown in these lines? 2 marks

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.....
.....

I (ii) · PRACTICE QUESTION

"I don't want them to make
my little girl a princess.
In tiny golden slippers
how could she play on the meadow?"

(a) Name the poem from which these lines are taken. Name the poet.

1 mark

(b) Who is the speaker?

1 mark

(c) What is the purpose of the question in the last line?

1 mark

(d) What does the image of 'tiny golden slippers' suggest?

2 marks

II PROSE

II (i) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"Your voice doesn't sound like aunt's," objected Nicholas; "you may be the Evil One tempting me to be disobedient."

(a) Name the text from which these lines are taken. Name the author.

1 mark

(b) To whom is Nicholas speaking?

1 mark

(c) Where is the aunt at this moment?

1 mark

(d) What features of Nicholas are revealed by these words?

2 marks

II (ii) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"How can this man value his life less than mine? His sincerity was overwhelming. I felt humbled."

(a) Name the text from which these lines are taken. Name the speaker/author. 1 mark

(b) Who is 'this man'? 1 mark

(c) What kind of question is the first sentence? 1 mark

(d) What does this show about the speaker? 2 marks

III DRAMA

III (i) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"Yes, that's what the town-folk call it! They say cloth of that sort cannot be seen unless they go to the 'Tenjiku' (Heaven). It's as valuable as that."

(a) Name the play from which these lines are taken. Name the playwright. 1 mark

(b) Who is the speaker, and to whom? 1 mark

(c) What are they talking about? 1 mark

(d) Why is this conversation important for the plot? 2 marks

III (ii) • PRACTICE QUESTION

"You may have buried yourself alive, but you haven't forgotten to powder your face!"

(a) Name the play from which these lines are taken. Name the playwright.

1 mark

(b) Who speaks these words, and to whom?

1 mark

(c) What does 'buried yourself alive' refer to?

1 mark

(d) What is the speaker suggesting? How does the listener react?

2 marks

Paper I • Section B: Novels 10 marks

Select **EITHER** I, II **OR** III and answer all the questions given below it.

I • THE PRINCE AND THE PAUPER

Read the following extract from *The Prince and the Pauper* by Mark Twain and answer all the questions given below it.

"I think the woman hath said true. An' my mother were in her place and gifted with the devil's functions, she had not stayed a moment to call her storms and lay the whole land in ruins, if the saving of my forfeit life were the price she got! It is argument that other mothers are made in like mould. Thou art free, goodwife—thou and thy child—for I do think thee innocent. Now thou'st nought to fear, being pardoned—pull off thy stockings!—an' thou canst make me a storm, thou shalt be rich!"

The redeemed creature was loud in her gratitude, and proceeded to obey, whilst Tom looked on with eager expectancy, a little marred by apprehension; the courtiers at the same time manifesting decided discomfort and uneasiness."

(i) When and where does this incident take place?

2 marks

(ii) Why does Tom decide that the woman is innocent?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) other mothers are made in like mould

1 mark

(b) a little marred by apprehension

1 mark

(iv) What does this incident reveal about Tom? Why is it also humorous?

4 marks

II • BRINGING TONY HOME

The narrator has returned to his old neighbourhood. In the middle of a gathering at Mrs. Jayasingha's, he hears a familiar sound:

"And then came the bark; the sharp clipped aristocratic bark, and with it came Tony"

(i) What is the situation, and where does it take place?

2 marks

(ii) Why is Tony so excited?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) sharp clipped

1 mark

(b) aristocratic

1 mark

(iv) Comment on the narrator's description of Tony's bark. What does it reveal about their relationship?

4 marks

III - THE VENDOR OF SWEETS

Mali has just arrived home from America with a young woman. A crowd and a photographer are present. Jagan is confused, but holds back his questions because:

"Any indiscreet question might upset the gentlemen with the camera."

(i) When and where does this happen?

2 marks

(ii) What has confused Jagan?

2 marks

(iii) Explain the meaning of the following phrase as it occurs in the passage: (a) indiscreet question

1 mark

(b) upset the gentlemen with the camera

1 mark

(iv) What does this incident reveal about Jagan and about the change in Mali?

4 marks

Paper II · Essays 60 marks

PAPER II · 60 MARKS

Answer **four** questions, selecting **one** each from the four sections: Poetry, Drama, Prose and Fiction.

HOW PAPER II ESSAYS ARE MARKED (15 MARKS EACH)

Content 7 · Organisation 4 · Language 4. Examiners reward relevant points from the text, apt quotations, a clear argument that answers the question, and your own sensible response. The points below are a guide, not a fixed list.

POETRY (Answer one question only)

1. How does Emily Dickinson use unusual images to describe the bird in 'A Bird Came Down the Walk'? 15 marks

2. "In 'Breakfast', Prévert tells a whole story through simple actions." Discuss. 15 marks

3. Examine how Maya Angelou uses contrast in 'I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings'. 15 marks

4. "'The Earthen Goblet' is a lament for lost freedom and natural beauty." Discuss. 15 marks

5. How does Edward Lowbury use repetition and a twist ending in 'The Huntsman'? 15 marks

DRAMA (Answer one question only)

6. Discuss the importance of the cloth (senba-ori) in 'Twilight of a Crane'. 15 marks

7. "Popova changes more than Smirnov in 'The Bear'." Do you agree? 15 marks

PROSE (Answer one question only)

8. How does the writer use language to convey confusion and terror in the extract from 'Wave'?

15 marks

9. What does the lumber-room represent in 'The Lumber Room'?

15 marks

10. "'We are Sri Lankan.' How does 'The Lahore Attack' express national pride and unity?"

15 marks

11. "The ending of 'The Nightingale and the Rose' is bitterly ironic." Discuss.

15 marks

FICTION (Answer one question only)

12. "Edward's sufferings among the poor teach him to be a better king." Discuss.

15 marks

13. Discuss the narrator's courage and determination in 'Bringing Tony Home'.

15 marks

14. "Jagan's Gandhian ideals are more convenient than sincere." Do you agree?

15 marks

These are original LitHelp practice questions written to the format of the G.C.E. (O/L) 2023(2024) and 2024(2025) papers and the Ministry of Education's 2025(2026) model papers. They are not official past-paper questions. For copyrighted set texts, only short lines are quoted and the situation is described in our own words.